

Hebrews 12:26b-27

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- Hebrews chapter 11 is sometimes referred to as “the hall of faith” because it not only defines what faith is (Heb. 11:1-3) but it also shows what faith looks like using named examples of people we can read about in the bible (Heb. 11:4-35) and also unnamed people who suffered grievously (Heb. 11:36-38). One of the many things we can learn from Hebrews 11 is that no matter what is going on and what things look like – keep your faith in God.

1 Peter 2:19-20

For this is thankworthy, if a man for conscience toward God endure grief, suffering wrongfully. [20] For what glory is it, if, when ye be buffeted for your faults, ye shall take it patiently? but if, when ye do well, and suffer for it, ye take it patiently, this is acceptable with God.

Hebrews 11:6 teaches us that it is impossible to please God without faith.

Hebrews 11:6

But without faith it is impossible to please him: for he that cometh to God must believe that he is, and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.

We learn more details about the people mentioned in the “hall of faith” in Hebrews 11.

Hebrews 11:4

By faith Abel offered unto God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, by which he obtained witness that he was righteous, God testifying of his gifts: and by it he being dead yet speaketh.

Hebrews 11:7

By faith Noah, being warned of God of things not seen as yet, moved with fear, prepared an ark to the saving of his house; by the which he condemned the world, and became heir of the righteousness which is by faith.

Hebrews 11:11

Through faith also Sara herself received strength to conceive seed, and was delivered of a child when she was past age, because she judged him faithful who had promised.

Hebrews 11:17-19

By faith Abraham, when he was tried, offered up Isaac: and he that had received the promises offered up his only begotten son, [18] Of whom it was said, That in Isaac shall thy seed be called: [19] Accounting that God was able to raise him up, even from the dead; from whence also he received him in a figure.

Hebrews 11:24-27

By faith Moses, when he was come to years, refused to be called the son of Pharaoh's daughter; [25] Choosing rather to suffer affliction with the people of God, than to enjoy the pleasures of sin for a season; [26] Esteeming the reproach of Christ greater riches than the treasures in Egypt: for he had respect unto the recompence of the reward. [27] By faith he forsook Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king: for he endured, as seeing him who is invisible.

Verses 25-27 are all one sentence.

Hebrews 12:25-27

See that ye refuse not him that speaketh. For if they escaped not who refused him that spake on earth, much more shall not we escape, if we turn away from him that speaketh from heaven: [26] Whose voice then shook the earth: but now he hath promised, saying, Yet once more I shake not the earth only, but also heaven. [27] And this word, Yet once more, signifieth the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that are made, that those things which cannot be shaken may remain.

Back to the beginning of chapter 12.

Hebrews 12:1-3

Wherefore seeing we also are compassed about with so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which doth so easily beset us, and let us run with patience the race that is set before us, [2] Looking unto Jesus the author and finisher of our faith; who for the joy that was set before him endured the cross, despising the shame, and is set down at the right hand of the throne of God. [3] For consider him that endured such contradiction of sinners against himself, lest ye be wearied and faint in your minds.

- Among other things Hebrews 12 is an exhortation to persevere in faith just like those examples that were given in the previous chapter. Hebrews 12 begins with an exhortation to look to Jesus and consider what He endured to avoid being wearied or faint (discouraged or depressed).

We are encouraged to appreciate the chastening of the Lord.

Hebrews 12:4-11

Ye have not yet resisted unto blood, striving against sin. [5] And ye have forgotten the exhortation which speaketh unto you as unto children, My son, **despise not thou the chastening of the Lord, nor faint when thou art rebuked of him:** [6] **For whom the Lord loveth he chasteneth,** and scourgeth every son whom he receiveth. [7] If ye endure chastening, God dealeth with you as with sons; for what son is he whom the father chasteneth not? [8] But if ye be without chastisement, whereof all are partakers, then are ye bastards, and not sons. [9] Furthermore we have had fathers of our flesh which corrected us, and we gave them reverence: shall we not much rather be in subjection unto the Father of spirits, and live? [10] For they verily for a few days chastened us after their own pleasure; but he for our profit, that we might be partakers of his holiness. [11] Now no chastening for the present seemeth to be joyous, but grievous: nevertheless afterward it yieldeth the peaceable fruit of righteousness unto them which are exercised thereby.

Among other things **Hebrews 12:4-11** tells us to not be discouraged and to endure when the Lord chastens (educates or disciplines) us and compares the correction of our earthy fathers to the correction of the Lord. Earthy fathers chasten us for “their own pleasure” but the Lord chastens us “for our profit, that we might be partakers of his holiness.” This exhortation may seem out of place unless you consider not only what Jesus endured but also the chastening of Israel in the old testament. On many occasions it was their circumstances that were the chastening of the Lord. One common example in the book of **Judges** is when Israel forsook God and worshiped other gods in the promised land, how did the Lord chasten them and bring them back to Him? He raised up other nations that prevailed against Israel (they attacked and won). The circumstance that they found themselves in caused them to turn back to and cry out to God and then what was God’s response? He delivered them. In doing so, Israel was “corrected” (chastened).

Malachi 3:6a,6b

For I am the Lord, I change not;

God does not change, and so it's important before complaining about our circumstances to consider: is this the chastening of the Lord? Is the Lord trying to get my attention or teach me something? If so, why?

He does not afflict us willingly.

Lamentations 3:31-33

For the Lord will not cast off for ever: [32] But though he cause grief, yet will he have compassion according to the multitude of his mercies. [33] For he doth not afflict willingly nor grieve the children of men.

Continuing chapter 12.

Hebrews 12:12-17

Wherefore lift up the hands which hang down, and the feeble knees; [13] And make straight paths for your feet, lest that which is lame be turned out of the way; but let it rather be healed. [14] Follow^(pursue!) peace with all men, and holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord: [15] Looking diligently lest any man fail of the grace of God; lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you, and thereby many be defiled; [16] Lest there be any fornicator, or profane person, as Esau, who for one morsel of meat sold his birthright. [17] For ye know how that afterward, when he would have inherited the blessing, he was rejected: for he found no place of repentance, though he sought it carefully with tears.

- Hebrews 12:12-17 follows with advice on what to do in our “spiritual marathon” referred to in verse 1 in light of the previous exhortation.

Hebrews 12:18-24 are all one sentence.

Hebrews 12:18-24

For ye are not come unto the mount that might be touched, and that burned with fire, nor unto blackness, and darkness, and tempest, [19] And the sound of a trumpet, and the voice of words; which voice they that heard intreated that the word should not be spoken to them any more: [20] (For they could not endure that which was commanded, And if so much as a beast touch the mountain, it shall be stoned, or thrust through with a dart: [21] And so terrible was the sight, that Moses said, I exceedingly fear and quake:)^{Exodus 20:18,19} [22] But ye are come unto mount Sion, and unto the city of the living God, the heavenly Jerusalem, and to an innumerable company of angels, [23] To the general assembly and church of the firstborn, which are written in heaven, and to God the Judge of all, and to the spirits of just men made perfect, [24] And to Jesus the mediator of the new covenant, and to the blood of sprinkling, that speaketh better things than that of Abel.

Hebrews 4:16

Let us therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy, and find grace to help in time of need.

- We don't need to be afraid to approach God like they were in the old testament. However, we do need to be mindful of who we are talking or praying to. He's still the same God that struck fear into the hearts of many Hebrews at Mt. Sinai in order to help them to not sin (Exodus 20:20). They were so afraid that they reacted by requesting that Moses mediate for them.

Hebrews 12:25-29

See that ye refuse not him that speaketh. For if they escaped not who refused him that spake on earth, much more shall not we escape, if we turn away from him that speaketh from heaven: [26] Whose voice then shook the earth: **but now he hath promised, saying, Yet once more I shake not the earth only, but also heaven.** [27] And this word, Yet once more, signifieth the removing of those things that are shaken, as of things that are made, that those things which cannot be shaken may remain. [28] Wherefore we receiving a kingdom which cannot be moved, let us have grace, whereby we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear: [29] For our God is a consuming fire.

- That same God now speaks to us from heaven and we are told to not refuse him and we are reminded of what happened to the Hebrews in the wilderness wanderings (almost all of them wandered 40 years and did not enter into the promised land because of their sin).
- **Hebrews 12:26,27** is a reference to **Haggai 2:6,7**.

Haggai 2:1-9

In the seventh month, in the one and twentieth day of the month, came the word of the LORD by the prophet Haggai, saying, [2] Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, and to the residue of the people, saying, [3] Who is left among you that saw this house in her first glory?^(referring to the first temple, the one Solomon built) and how do ye see it now?^(it was destroyed by Babylon) is it not in your eyes in comparison of it as nothing? [4] Yet now be strong, O Zerubbabel, saith the LORD; and be strong, O Joshua, son of Josedech, the high priest; and be strong, all ye people of the land, saith the LORD, and work: for I am with you, saith the LORD of hosts: [5] According to the word that I covenanted with you when ye came out of Egypt, so my spirit remaineth among you: fear ye not. [6] **For thus saith the LORD of hosts; Yet once, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, and the earth, and the sea, and the dry land;** [7] **And I will shake all nations, and the desire^(delight) of all nations shall come: and I will fill this house with glory, saith the LORD of hosts.** [8] The silver is mine, and the gold is mine, saith the LORD of hosts. [9] The glory of this latter house shall be greater than of the former, saith the LORD of hosts: and in this place will I give peace, saith the LORD of hosts.

- Zerubbabel was among the returning captives after Persia conquered Babylon (of which the Hebrews were captives for 70 years).
- They are encouraged by God to work and build a new temple thus fulfilling the prophecy in **Daniel 9:25** (Daniel was a prophet during the Babylonian/Chaldean captivity).
- The second temple was the temple that Jesus and His disciples visited and it stood until 70AD when it was destroyed by the Romans (which Jesus forewarned about in **Matthew 24:2**, **Mark 13:2**, **Luke 19:44**, and **Luke 21:6**).

- But, what is this shaking referring to exactly? **Hebrews 12:26,27** gives us some clues.

Hebrews 12:26,27

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2 Corinthians 4:18

While we look not at the things which are seen, but at the things which are not seen: for **the things which are seen are temporal**; but **the things which are not seen are eternal**.

- The things which are seen are physical and temporary, the things which are not seen are spiritual and eternal.

The first of three biblical references to a new heaven and a new earth occurs in Isaiah.

Isaiah 65:17

For, behold, **I create new heavens and a new earth**: and the former shall not be remembered, nor come into mind.

...

Isaiah 66:22

For as **the new heavens and the new earth, which I will make**, shall remain before me, saith the LORD, so shall your seed and your name remain.

The third (in book order) occurs in Revelation.

Revelation 21:1-5

And I saw **a new heaven** and **a new earth**: for **the first heaven** and **the first earth were passed away**; and there was no more sea. [2] And I John saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. [3] And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God. [4] And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain: for **the former things are passed away**. [5] And he that sat upon the throne said, **Behold, I make all things new**. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful.

The second occurs in 2 Peter.

2 Peter 3:10-13

But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night; in the which **the heavens shall pass away with a great noise, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat, the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up**. [11] Seeing then that **all these things shall be dissolved**, what manner of persons ought ye to be in all holy conversation and godliness, [12] Looking for and hasting unto the coming of the day of God, wherein **the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the elements shall melt with fervent heat?** [13] Nevertheless **we, according to his promise, look for new heavens and a new earth**, wherein dwelleth righteousness.

- Before the new heavens and new earth appear the old things must “pass away” and [2 Peter 3:10-13](#) gives us more details as to how that will happen. Take note also that Hebrews chapter 12 ends with “For our God is a consuming fire.”
- For this verse study it’s important to note from the verse above: “the earth also and the works that are therein shall be burned up” The question that immediately follows calls attention to that fact and causes us to consider a very important point: Where should our focus of our life be in light of this knowledge? Should we be pursuing earthly/physical/temporary things that will amount to nothing? Or, should we pursue the spiritual things which are eternal?
- Obviously, we need some of those physical/temporal things to get by – so then it naturally becomes not about abstaining from them but instead about our priorities.
- Likewise, [Hebrews 12:26b-27](#) is a reminder of the brevity and temporary nature of the physical world that we see and the works thereof versus pursuing eternal things which are spiritual. It helps us to properly prioritize our lives into a meaningful manner as opposed to what the world teaches: spiritual/eternal things come first, physical/temporal things follow.
- Is there anywhere in your life where you are prioritizing temporal over eternal?

What did Jesus say about this topic:

[Matthew 6:19-21](#)

Lay not up for yourselves treasures upon earth, where moth and rust doth corrupt, and where thieves break through and steal: [20] But lay up for yourselves treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust doth corrupt, and where thieves do not break through nor steal: [21] For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

At some point in the future, the following events will occur (Revelation, Daniel, et. al):

Biblical event (chronological order)	Common name
Christ returns with His holy angels and “harvests the earth”	Rapture
7 year period when divine judgments, celestial disturbances, natural disasters, and terrible plagues come to pass (some will turn to the Lord and some will still refuse)	Tribulation (the tribulation and great tribulation period are evenly split at 3.5 years), God’s wrath is poured upon the earth
The “beast” is defeated by the Lamb, the Lord of lords, and King of kings. The “beast” and the false prophet are cast alive into the lake of fire burning with brimstone.	The marriage supper of the Lamb
Satan is bound in the bottomless pit for 1,000 years and Jesus and the saints of the first resurrection live and reign on the earth for 1,000 years	Millennial kingdom
After the millennial kingdom Satan is let loose for a short season, he again gathers the nations to do battle against the saints and the beloved city and just after they encamp around the city fire from heaven comes down and devours them	
Great white throne judgment	Final judgment
Revelation 21:1 And I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea. Revelation 21:5 And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful.	The old heaven and earth are passed away and the new heaven and earth appears